

Value Stream Map Canvas (DP §4)

Day 4 · Activities 1–4 handout. The one-page canvas for mapping your feature's delivery stream: steps, process time, lead time, queues, and total flow efficiency.

Draw this on a whiteboard or large paper. The visual makes the queues hit emotionally. Aim for **7–10 steps** (more = over-decomposed; fewer = lumping).

The canvas

[Step 1] → [Step 2] → [Step 3] → ...

PT: __	PT: __	PT: __
LT: __	LT: __	LT: __

QUEUE	QUEUE	QUEUE
__ items	__ items	__ items
__ days	__ days	__ days

Total cycle time: __ days
Total process time: __ days
Total flow efficiency: __%

Per-step worksheet

Fill one row per step. Use real data where available (ADO data; team retros). Otherwise estimate honestly — and label it an estimate.

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS	OWNER (ROLE)	PT	LT	FLOW EFF (PT/LT)	NOTES

Worked sample — FieldPulse reconcile

STEP	PT	LT	FLOW EFF	NOTES
Idea	1 hour (signal review)	3 days (queue at TPM's calendar)	5%	Signal sometimes lost in inbox
Discovery	4 hours	2 days	25%	Often blocked on customer-interview scheduling
Spec	16 hours	2 weeks	22%	Multiple stakeholder review cycles
Estimate + accept	1 hour	1 week (queue for sprint planning)	3%	One sprint planning per 2 weeks
Build	8 hours per story	1 week per story (mid-sprint)	14%	Multi-tasking; dependency wait
Code review	30 min review	1.5 days waiting for reviewer	4%	Reviewer queue
QA + integration	4 hours	2 days	12%	QA staffing constraint
Deploy	30 min ship	6 hours (deploy windows)	8%	Daily deploy schedule
Measure	1 hour per check	30 days for outcome	n/a	Inherent waiting (data accrual)

Total cycle time idea-to-deploy: ~6–8 weeks. Total flow efficiency for the whole stream: typically **5–15%**.

Optional: AI critique of your VSM

```
Role: Lean coach reviewing a software value stream.
Context: <description of the VSM with PT/LT/flow eff numbers
        and identified queues>
Task: Identify 3 queues likely missing or under-counted:
  1. A queue between two steps not yet shown
  2. A step where PT and LT seem out of line with team reality
  3. An invisible queue (e.g., approvals, "ping someone")
Constraints:
  - Use only the data given
  - Be specific
Format: 3 numbered findings – what's missing / why suspect / how to verify.
```

What "good" looks like

- Numbers are **honest**, even if estimated (and estimates are flagged as estimates).
- Flow efficiency is **computed** (a single-digit number is typical and informative).

- Distinguish a **systemic queue** (waste) from a **necessary delay** (e.g., 30 days for outcome data is not a bug).